



MODULE 1

Self-Knowledge as a Coach

Who are you as a coach — and how does that affect what happens with your players?

CORE THEORY

Coaches are the most influential adults in young athletes' lives, after parents. But that influence is never neutral: it always reflects who the coach is as a person. The Johari Window (Luft & Ingham, 1955) shows that effective coaching starts with shrinking your "blind spot" — the things others see in you that you don't see yourself. Coaches with high self-awareness use power, pressure, and relationships more consciously.

Source: Luft & Ingham (1955) · Rhind & Jowett (2010) · Côté & Gilbert (2009)

"Before you are a leader, success is all about growing yourself. When you become a leader, success is all about growing others."
— Jack Welch

"You can only lead others as far as you have led yourself."
— John Maxwell

SELF-REFLECTION

- 1 What three values define you as a coach? Where do those come from?
- 2 When were you least proud of yourself as a coach this past month? What does that say about you?
- 3 What player behavior triggers you most strongly — and why do you think that is?
- 4 How would a player from last year describe you now? Does that match who you want to be?
- 5 What is your biggest blind spot as a coach? Who is willing to tell you that honestly?

NOTES

**BOOKS**

- **Legacy**
James Kerr
Why: How the All Blacks build a culture from values and self-knowledge. Every chapter is a lesson in leading from within.
- **Dare to Lead**
Brené Brown
Why: On leading courageously through vulnerability. Required reading for every coach who wants to create real connection.
- **The Inner Game of Tennis**
W. Timothy Gallwey
Why: Classic work on the coach's inner voice. How your doubts and judgments influence player performance.
- **The Talent Code**
Daniel Coyle
Why: Why some coaches develop talent and others don't. Driven by self-awareness and targeted feedback.

**VIDEO'S / TED TALKS**

- **The Power of Vulnerability**
Brené Brown (TED Talk)
ted.com/talks/brene_brown_the_power_of_vulnerability
Watch: how vulnerability is courage, not weakness. Essential for coaches.
- **How Great Leaders Inspire Action**
Simon Sinek (TED Talk)
ted.com/talks/simon_sinek_how_great_leaders_inspire_action
The "Golden Circle": start with why. What is YOUR why as a coach?

**PODCASTS**

- **Finding Mastery**
Episode with Pete Carroll — coaching from values and identity
findingmastery.com
- **The High Performance Podcast**
Episode with Jürgen Klopp — who you are shapes how you coach
thehighperformancepodcast.com

⚡ ACTION THIS WEEK

Ask one trusted colleague or player this week: "What do you see in me as a coach that I might not see myself?" Write it down without defending yourself.

My personal growth point as a coach this season is:
